

A full circle

Microsoft likely to unveil the next Xbox, the Xbox 720 at E3 2012
<http://goo.gl/w3iUh>

There and back again

A game accompanying Peter Jackson's *Hobbit, An Unexpected Journey* is expected to be released next year

Feature

platform is Indie-friendly. It lets developers directly engage with their audience, for example, the Alphafunding feature allows one to purchase games while



they're still in development, which will allow for some much needed development funds for the creators.

Desura gives out games for Windows, Mac OS X and Linux. A Windows client and Beta version of the Linux client is already available, and eventually will expand to Mac OS X. You only need to purchase a game once to play it on all supported platforms. Like Impulse, it lists prices converted to INR.

The Outsiders

There are a few options we have left out here, and we should mention why.

Origin: As EA's official store, it doesn't have games from other publishers, and hence was not listed. Origin does have Indian pricing in its store if you access from India, which can make a huge difference. For example, the upcoming *Mass Effect 3* is available for ₹999 instead of the international price of \$59 (~₹3,000 currently). Some EA games may be exclusive to Origin soon. Origin also only guarantees that games you buy will be available to download up to a year from purchase.

Amazon: Amazon offers digital game downloads, but not for India. Case closed.

Direct2Drive: A glaring omission you might feel, but the fact is that this game store has severely restricted the number of games available in India. Only 10 per cent of its games are available in India.

OnLive: OnLive is a cloud-gaming platform. You don't download games, you essentially stream them off the net. You're simply watching a video of the game playing on a server and your inputs are going to its server to control the game. We haven't included it since the 4-16 mbps it needs is still rare in India, and it isn't a traditional store.

Pros:

- Store for Windows and Linux games rolled into one
- Mac OS X support incoming
- Very good mod support
- Good community features
- Support for modding games not

installed from Desura store

- Many games and mods available for free, which is great
- Early access to games in development via Alphafunding

Cons:

- Game client required

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